

Rationale and design of ADVANCE TRAUMA

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How does ATLS® training impact patient outcomes in comparison to standard care in adult trauma patients? (ClinicalTrials.gov NCT06321419)

Study design

Batched stepped-wedge cluster randomised trial comparing ATLS® vs standard care

Standard care

Training

Intervention

Uni-directional crossover trial: 30 clusters 6 batches

Population

Adult trauma patients in 30 hospitals across India. Target > 4320 patients

Primary outcome comparison

Standard care

In-hospital mortality within 30 days of arriving at the ED

ATLS® training

Intervention

Does ATLS® reduce in-hospital mortality from 20% to <15%?

If ATLS® improves patient outcomes it should be further promoted

OR

If ATLS® does not improve patient outcomes, trauma life support training needs to change

Rationale
ATLS® is the most widely adopted trauma life support training worldwide, but there is no high-quality evidence that it improves patient outcomes.

Aim
To compare the effects of ATLS® training with standard care on outcomes in adult trauma patients.

Status
This trial is ongoing since February 2025 and expect to end in 2029. Over 1,400 patients from ten hospitals have been included so far.

For more information about the trial, visit www.advancetrauma.info

This will be the first large-scale trial to provide evidence of the effectiveness of ATLS since the programme started in 1978!

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